

Andrew W. Kohler

Gameplay Engineer

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SKILLS —

- *Languages*
 - C | C++
 - C#
 - Python
 - Java
 - HTML5 | CSS
 - 68K Assembly
- *Tools*
 - UE5 (Blueprints, C++)
 - Unity 5/6
 - Perforce | P4 Code Review
 - Jira
 - Visual Studio 2022
 - GitHub
- Physics & 3D math
- Linear algebra
- Team management
- Agile development
- Pixel art

EDUCATION —

University of Central Florida Dec 2026
MS, Interactive Entertainment

- GPA: 4.0
- Honors and Awards:
 - 1st Place, FIEA Game Jam
 - Most Complete Experience, 68K Game Awards
 - Player's Choice, Rapid Prototype Awards
- Florida Interactive Entertainment Academy (FIEA) programming track

University of Florida May 2025
BS, Digital Arts and Sciences

- GPA: 3.90
- Honors and Awards:
 - Summa Cum Laude
 - Dean's List
 - Quest Scholar
 - Florida Academic Scholar
 - Gator-Aid Customer Service Award

WORK EXPERIENCE —

Lead Programmer, Studio Kismet

UE5, C++, Blueprints, P4V, Jira Oct 2025 - present

- Prototyped and currently leading iterative development on core movement mechanics of a high-speed, physics-based, 6-axis platformer in Unreal Engine
- Supporting developers by providing consistent performance reports via Unreal Insights profiling and conducting rapid code reviews

Peer Mentor, UF CISE Dept.

Blender, Canvas

Aug 2024 - May 2025

- Reviewed and graded 3D modeling and animation work in Blender for 30 students per semester (fall/spring)
- Directly interfaced with students during weekly office hours and over 20 labs, providing technical assistance and guidance on Blender tools and usage

Research Assistant, INDIE Lab

Unity 5, Meta SDK

May 2024 - Aug 2024

- Leveraged Meta Quest integration with Unity to develop a speculative research application for VR headsets
- Built on existing research groundwork to create a configurable demonstration space for virtual hand jitter

PROJECT EXPERIENCE —

FIEA Game Engine

Real-Time C++ Content System

Jan 2026 - Apr 2026

- Built a data-driven game engine that uses formatted JSON to dynamically initialize objects at runtime
- Utilized observer, chain of responsibility, builder, and singleton design patterns to create a usable architecture
- Completed extensive unit testing under a test-driven development style to validate systems

Final Fantasy I Recreation

C / OpenGL JRPG

Nov 2025 - Dec 2025

- Developed tooling to reinterpret JSON data generated from bitmap images to enable rapid map and NPC creation and collision integration
- Re-constructed FF1's battle, menu, and movement systems from scratch, including statistics, animations, sequencing, and original glitches

Undergraduate Game Thesis

Narrative-Heavy 3D Pixel Art

Jul 2024 - May 2025

- Utilized Unity Shader Graph and HLSL to prototype and implement a shader to limit 3D models to display only 2 colors, creating a 1-bit 3D aesthetic
- Implemented navmesh-based AI character system to allow for one player to swap between two characters seamlessly